

MAMMALS – PATHFINDER HONOR NOTES

1. What Are Mammals?

Mammals are a group of animals that are warm-blooded, have hair or fur on their bodies, and whose females produce milk to feed their young. Most mammals give birth to live young, although a few lay eggs. Mammals live on land, in water, and some can fly.

2. Day of Creation of Mammals

According to the Bible (Genesis 1:24–25), mammals were created on the sixth day of creation, together with reptiles and other land animals.

3. Characteristics of Mammals

The main characteristics of mammals include:

Presence of hair or fur

Ability of mothers to produce milk

Warm-blooded body temperature

Mostly give birth to live young

Well-developed brains

4. Orders of Mammals and Examples

a. Marsupialia

Marsupials give birth to immature young that develop in a pouch. Examples include kangaroos, wallabies, and opossums.

b. Insectivora

These mammals feed mainly on insects and have sharp teeth. Examples include moles, shrews, and hedgehogs.

c. Chiroptera

These are flying mammals that use echolocation. Examples include bats.

d. Carnivora

Carnivores eat meat and have strong jaws and sharp teeth. Examples include lions, leopards, dogs, and cats.

e. Pinnipedia

Semi-aquatic mammals with flippers. Examples include seals, sea lions, and walruses.

f. Rodentia

Rodents have continuously growing front teeth. Examples include rats, mice, squirrels, and porcupines.

g. Lagomorpha

Similar to rodents but with two pairs of upper incisors. Examples include rabbits and hares.

h. Artiodactyla

Even-toed hoofed mammals. Examples include cattle, goats, sheep, antelopes, and deer.

i. Sirenia

Fully aquatic plant-eating mammals. Examples include manatees and dugongs.

j. Cetacea

Completely aquatic mammals adapted for life in water. Examples include whales, dolphins, and porpoises.

5. Beneficial Mammals

Cows provide milk, meat, and leather.

Goats provide meat, milk, and manure.

Dogs provide security and help herd animals.

Bats control insects and help in pollination.

6. Harmful Effects of Mammals

Some destroy crops (rats, monkeys).

Some spread diseases (rats, bats).

Some attack livestock (lions, hyenas).

Some can be dangerous to humans.

7. Completely Aquatic Mammals

Examples include whales, dolphins, manatees, and porpoises, which live entirely in water.

8. Largest Mammal in the World

The blue whale is the largest mammal. It lives in the ocean, feeds by filtering water, and eats krill.

9. Wild Mammals Observed

Examples include elephants, monkeys, rats, dogs, cats, goats, bats, and cows.

10. Story: A Wild Mammal I Have Observed

I observed a monkey in a forest. It moved quickly through trees while feeding on fruits. When it sensed danger, it escaped fast, showing how mammals adapt to survive.